Combat rule – Ranged attacks in close combat and long range · SRD 5.2.1

A ranged weapon has two ranges: **normal range** and **long range**. Beyond normal range, the attack has **disadvantage**. Beyond long range, it's **impossible**.

Shooting while an enemy who can **see** you is within **5 ft** also gives **disadvantage**.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. **Normal** range: normal roll.
2. **Long** range: **disadvantage**.
3. Beyond long range: **impossible**.
4. Able enemy within **5 ft**: **disadvantage**.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 keeps these rules. The close-combat disadvantage applies to ranged attack rolls, spells included.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't say whether a blind or unconscious enemy counts. Fix: only an enemy **that can see you and isn't Incapacitated** imposes the disadvantage.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe the shooter's tension as an enemy's breath is felt before the shot.

Step 1 – Measure:

Count the distance between you and the target.

Step 2 – Compare:

Normal range? Long range? Beyond?

Step 3 – Check contact:

Is an enemy that sees you and isn't Incapacitated within 5 ft?

Step 4 – Combine:

Disadvantages don't stack: one is enough, however many apply.

Step 5 – Avoid:

Step back with **Disengage**, or strike in melee.

Example: Tarn shoots a longbow at a target 200 ft away (normal range 150 ft): disadvantage. A goblin 5 ft away still means only one disadvantage.

Weapon	Normal / long range
Shortbow, light crossbow	80 / 320 ft
Longbow	150 / 600 ft
Heavy crossbow	100 / 400 ft
Hand crossbow, sling	30 / 120 ft
Javelin	30 / 120 ft
Dagger, handaxe, spear (thrown)	20 / 60 ft
Dart	20 / 60 ft

⚠ Common questions:

What does 150/600 mean?

Normal 150 ft, long 600 ft.

Can I shoot beyond long range?

No.

Does contact affect spells?

Yes, ranged attack rolls.

Do disadvantages stack?

No, only one counts.

Does a blind enemy count?

No, it must see you.

Do thrown weapons have ranges?

Yes, e.g. 20/60 ft for a dagger.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Ammunition

What when it runs out? **Option**: improvised weapon.

Strong wind

Does it reduce range? **Option**: normal range halved.

Several adjacent foes

Do they change anything? **Option**: no.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

One disadvantage

Several sources don't stack.

Out of range

Beyond long range the attack is impossible.

Thrown dagger

It uses its own range pair.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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